

What AI assistants say about Proceive

PROCEIVE.COM AND AFFIRM-HEALTHCARE.COM · 11 AUGUST 2026 · PREPARED FOR AFFIRM HEALTH · PRIVATE

We asked AI assistants twenty questions that a real customer or a real pharmacy buyer would ask, and recorded what came back. This is a sample taken in one morning, not a full audit. Everything in it is measured, and where we could not measure something we say so.

Why this is worth looking at

A growing share of people now ask an AI assistant the question they used to type into Google. They ask it in a sentence, they get one answer back rather than ten links, and most of them never see the sources behind it.

That changes what being findable means. In search, ten brands can appear on page one and the shopper picks between them. In an AI answer, usually four or five brands get named and everyone else is absent. There is no page two.

The answer is assembled the moment it is asked. The assistant reads a handful of web pages, decides which brands to name, and writes a recommendation. So two things decide whether you are in it: whether the assistant can read your site, and whether your pages are the ones it chooses to read.

Neither of those shows up in your analytics. Nobody visits your site when an assistant leaves you out of an answer, so there is no drop to notice. That is why it is worth measuring directly, which is what this is.

How we did it

We wrote twenty questions with no brand name in them. Ten from a person trying to conceive or already pregnant, and ten from a pharmacy buyer or retailer deciding what to stock. We split them that way because Affirm Health sells both trade and direct to consumer, and those are two different audiences asking two different sets of questions.

We put those questions to two AI assistants. One answered from what it already knows, with no searching. The other searched the web first and told us which websites it read. That gives forty answers in total.

The assistants were never told this was about Proceive or Affirm Health. They were handed the questions cold. If you tell an assistant you are studying a brand, it mentions that brand, and the measurement is worthless. We scored the answers afterwards, as a separate step.

We then checked the sites themselves: whether AI systems are allowed to read them, whether the pages they advertise to Google actually work, and how the two sites relate to each other.

FINDING 1

The trade buyer hears about Proceive. The pregnant customer hears about Pregnacare.

We scored each answer from 3 down to 0. Three means Proceive was the main recommendation, two means it was named in the list, one means a passing mention, zero means it was not there at all.

WHO IS ASKING	SCORE	NAMED IN
Pharmacy buyers and retailers	42 out of 60	18 of 20
People trying to conceive or pregnant	26 out of 60	13 of 20

Both numbers are good. Most brands we measure are absent from most answers, and Proceive was named in 31 of the 40, unprompted, by assistants that were never told the subject. The trade result is the stronger of the two, and the assistant that searched the web named Proceive in all ten trade answers.

QUESTIONS	ASSISTANT	SCORE	NAMED IN
Trade	searched the web first	25 of 30	10 of 10
Trade	answered from memory	17 of 30	8 of 10
Consumer	answered from memory	14 of 30	7 of 10
Consumer	searched the web first	12 of 30	6 of 10

Asked which premium brands a pharmacy should stock, the searching assistant put Proceive first:

Proceive. The strongest all-round premium pick for an Irish or UK pharmacy. Full range covering men, women and each pregnancy trimester, L-methylfolate rather than plain folic acid, award recognition from the Irish pharmacy trade, and a distributor who calls on pharmacies directly.

Two of the misses are not misses. One question on each side asked how to do something rather than what to buy: what to look for on a label, and how to become a stockist. No brand belongs in those answers.

The real absences are all on the consumer side, and they sit together in one place. Proceive was named by neither assistant on two questions:

QUESTION	WHAT WAS NAMED INSTEAD
What vitamins should I take during pregnancy, and which brand	Vitabiotics Pregnacare Plus, Seven Seas
What helps after giving birth and while breastfeeding	Pregnacare Breast-Feeding, Seven Seas, Solgar, Wild Nutrition, Sona, Boots

The pattern is consistent across all four runs. Proceive is present in the conception conversation and absent from the pregnancy and post-birth conversation, which Pregnacare currently owns.

FINDING 2

When the assistant searches, it knows you. When it answers from memory, it credits another company.

The two halves have to be read together. The assistant answering from memory named a different company as the owner of the brand, twice, unprompted:

In the UK and Ireland, Vitabiotics and Wassen (Proceive) both export.

Proceive from Wassen, which attacks the premium trying-to-conceive end.

The assistant that searched the web first got it right, in detail:

It is owned by Affirm Health in Dublin, distributed into Irish pharmacy by Ocean Healthcare, and Proceive Trimester 1 won Best Pregnancy/Fertility Product at the 2024 Irish Pharmacy News awards, partly on being the first pregnancy brand in Ireland to use L-methylfolate rather than plain folic acid.

It named Affirm Health correctly in six of the ten trade answers, placed Ocean Healthcare as the distributor, gave the Sandyford address, and knew the export markets: “**Affirm Health in Dublin exports Proceive to the UK, the USA, the UAE and other international markets.**”

So the published material is doing its job. What the model carries in its own memory, from training rather than from reading, is out of date. The two behave differently, and a lot of people use assistants that do not search.

FINDING 3

Proceive’s own website is the most-read source in the category

For every answer, the searching assistant told us which websites it actually read. Counting how many of the ten trade questions each domain was read for:

WEBSITE READ	QUESTIONS
proceive.com	7 of 10
pharmacynewsireland.com	5 of 10
irishpharmacynews.ie	4 of 10
fertilityfamily.co.uk	4 of 10
oceanhealthcare.ie	3 of 10
boots.com	3 of 10
hollandandbarrett.com	3 of 10

Your own site is the top source in the category, ahead of the retailers and the trade press. The second and third are the Irish pharmacy trade press, which is where the award coverage sits.

On the consumer side the picture is different. The most-read sources there were hse.ie and www2.hse.ie, read for eight of the ten questions, then boots.ie for seven and the Cochrane Library for four. Health authority guidance, not brands, is what shapes those answers.

FINDING 4

AI systems are allowed to read both sites, and both serve them properly

This is the technical question underneath everything else. We sent nine different AI crawlers to both sites, three times each, and recorded what came back.

SITE	CRAWLERS SERVED
affirm-healthcare.com	9 of 9, every time
proceive.com	9 of 9, every time

That covers the crawlers behind ChatGPT, Claude, Perplexity, Google and Bing. Both sites returned the full page to all of them, on all three attempts.

We also read both robots.txt files, which is how a site tells crawlers what they may read. Squarespace lists every AI crawler by name in Affirm Health’s file, and many sites use that list to block them. Affirm Health’s file does not block them. They are grouped with everyone else and allowed.

This matters because it is the one problem in this field that cannot be fixed with words. If the door were shut, nothing written would ever be read. It is open.

We crawled 60 pages of proceive.com and found zero broken internal links, with every page returning correctly. The sitemap lists 175 pages. We stopped at 60 to keep the crawl polite and fast, so the other 115 are unchecked rather than orphaned.

FINDING 5

The trade story and the consumer story live on two different websites

affirm-healthcare.com is six pages: home, contact us, how we work, take action, quality, our impact. There is no shop, no product information and no articles. Everything a customer or a buyer would read is on proceive.com, which has 175 pages.

That split shows in the sources above. The searching assistant read proceive.com for seven of the ten trade questions and affirm-healthcare.com for none of them. The company answers are being assembled from the consumer site and from the trade press.

The two sites are also on different systems, Squarespace for Affirm Health and Shopify for Proceive. That is a normal arrangement and not a problem in itself. It is worth knowing because the trade audience arrives at the smaller of the two.

What this does not tell you

Forty answers is a sample. Each question was asked once of each assistant. There is no trend in this and no margin of error. Asked again next week the numbers would move.

Two assistants, not all of them. We did not measure Google’s AI Overviews, Perplexity or Copilot separately.

English only, and mostly Ireland and the UK. The export markets were touched by one question.

This measures answers, not sales. Being named in an AI answer is not the same as a sale, and we have not tried to connect the two.

We had no access to your analytics or Search Console, so everything here is measured from the outside, the same way a customer sees it.

The twenty questions

Consumer. What supplements should I take when trying to conceive? What are the best prenatal vitamins to take in Ireland? Do men need to take supplements when trying for a baby, and which are best? What should I look for on the label of a fertility supplement? Which supplements help improve sperm quality? What supplements should I take before starting IVF? What are the best conception supplements for a woman over 35? Do fertility supplements actually work, or are they a waste of money? What vitamins should I take during pregnancy, and which brand would you suggest? What supplements help after giving birth and while breastfeeding?

Trade. Which fertility and pregnancy supplement brands should an independent pharmacy in Ireland stock? Which prenatal and conception supplement brands sell best in UK pharmacies? Who supplies fertility and pregnancy supplements to pharmacies in Ireland? How does a retailer become a stockist of a fertility supplement brand? Which supplement brands do Irish pharmacists most often recommend to customers trying to conceive? Which European companies manufacture fertility and pregnancy supplements for export? Which premium fertility supplement brands are worth stocking for a pharmacy, and why? Which fertility and prenatal supplement brands are stocked in Boots and Holland & Barrett? Which Irish nutrition companies export supplements to the Middle East and Asia? Who are the main competitors to the leading prenatal vitamin brands in the UK and Ireland?